

SCOTT BAKER

VP, Product Marketing | Positioning, GTM & Sales Enablement Leader

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Product marketing executive with 15+ years leading positioning, messaging, and go-to-market for complex B2B technology portfolios. The throughline across every role: take an underdeveloped or informal product marketing function and build it into the positioning, launch, and competitive intelligence engine other teams' model themselves on. Built and led product marketing organizations at Pure Storage, Hitachi Vantara, and HPE, each time formalizing the launch playbook, sales enablement, and buyer/competitive research that moved the number. Currently CMO at IBM, where product marketing sits at the center of a \$5.4B AI-infrastructure business. Former software engineer (NASA, EMC) with patents in AI-driven infrastructure that translates deeply technical products into positioning and value propositions that buyers and sales teams actually use.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Positioning & Messaging • Go-to-Market Strategy • Product Launches • Sales Enablement & Battlecards • Competitive Intelligence • Buyer Personas & Market Research • Product Marketing Team Leadership • Demand Gen Partnership • Analyst & Press Relations • Cross-Functional Leadership (Product, Engineering, Sales) • Narrative & Storytelling • Technical Product Translation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

CMO & VP of IBM AI-Infrastructure Product Marketing and Communications — IBM *May 2021 – Present*

- Own positioning, messaging architecture, and GTM strategy for IBM's \$5.4B AI-infrastructure portfolio, leading a global product marketing organization within a broader marketing org of 24 direct reports (~50 matrixed).
- Led the positioning and messaging behind the IBM Storage brand transformation from product-centric to solutions- and category-led, reigniting a stagnant business to 52% above profit objectives year on year.
- Own competitive intelligence and analyst relations (Gartner, IDC, Forrester); serve as keynote speaker and press spokesperson on AI-ready infrastructure and operationalizing AI.
- Partner directly with engineering leadership to shape the product roadmap, translating patented, deeply technical storage capabilities into buyer-ready differentiation.
- Conceived and led development of an internal market-intelligence tool that ingests competitor, analyst, and press signals and flags when shifts require action on narrative or positioning.
- Partner with demand generation to fuel pipeline with launch-driven narratives; drove 240% growth in partner/channel revenue in 18 months.

Vice President of Product Marketing — Pure Storage *Jan 2020 – May 2021*

- Recruited to build and lead product marketing for the billion-dollar FlashArray and Cloud Block Store (SaaS) portfolio; built a team of 20 product and technical marketers, growing headcount 45%.
- Built a repeatable launch playbook adopted company-wide that improved launches 30%, rep participation 20%, and conversion 25%.
- Owned competitive intelligence and the analyst relations program that moved the portfolio to #1 recognized leadership (Gartner, IDC, ESG, 451, GigaOm).
- Replaced an ad hoc, micro-managed structure with a formal product marketing framework and improved retention 68%, content utilization 92%, and website engagement 21%.
- Partnered with demand generation to drive 23%+ YoY marketing-sourced pipeline through sales-stage ABM and enablement.

Sr. Director, Product & Technical Marketing — Hitachi Vantara *Nov 2015 – Jan 2020*

- Led product and technical marketing for a global, matrixed team of 45 focused on positioning, messaging, and GTM across the object storage, content, and data-intelligence portfolio.
- Built a persona/vertical demand model translating technical capabilities into buyer-relevant narratives; +38% lead gen, 2x qualification, \$10.5M incremental revenue.

- Acted as de facto product manager for Content Intelligence, translating deeply technical capabilities into market-ready positioning; shipped one year ahead of schedule and grew a developer community to 100+ contributors.
- Owned competitive intelligence and authored Intelligent Data Governance for Dummies, earning leadership placement in Gartner MQ, Forrester Wave, and IDC MarketScape.
- Expanded installed base 43% and grew loyalty 30%, contributing \$500M first-year revenue and 14% YoY growth.

Director, Technical Marketing — Hewlett-Packard (HPE)

Jun 2013 – Nov 2015

- Built the technical product marketing organization from the ground up, grew the team from a department of one to 9 domain experts, and formalized the launch and positioning framework later scaled at Pure Storage.
- Owned go-to-market strategy, competitive intelligence, and sales enablement for the Data Protect and Information Lifecycle Management software stack.
- Exceeded a \$500M quota on a flat budget through targeted sales plays and campaigns.
- Accelerated pipeline velocity 12%, cut time-in-funnel 28%, and quadrupled qualified leads.

EARLY CAREER

Director, VMware Solutions & Sr. Manager, Virtualization and Cloud Engineering — NetApp (2011 – 2013) — Led technical assessment and virtualization engineering teams spanning NetApp's VMware, big data, and enterprise application solutions.

Manager, VMware Field Enablement & Manager, Software Engineering — EMC (2004 – 2011) — Led field enablement and software engineering teams building data management tools, VMware integrations, storage replication tools, and client-side solutions for EMC's enterprise storage platforms: Celerra, CLARiiON, VNX, and VMAX.

Managing Director, Software Development — Elsinore Technologies (1998 – 2004) — Co-founded and led software development, services, and marketing for the company's core product suite and next-generation framework for software defect tracking and issue management targeting software development teams that standardized on Microsoft development tools and environments.

Senior Software Engineer — NASA (1996 – 1998) — Designed and deployed real-time embedded systems responsible for controlling, managing, and monitoring International Space Station status changes and telemetry data within 0.01 seconds, including MIL-STD-1553 firmware.

Electronic Communications Analyst — U.S. Army (1989) — Led signals intelligence teams and built threat-modeling and intelligence-reporting applications deployed on the US Army RC-135 mid-altitude intelligence collection platform for both tactical, including deployment during Operation Desert Shield/Desert Storm, and strategic environments.

EDUCATION & PATENTS

MBA, New Venture Management — University of North Alabama

Certificate, Enterprise Ready Leadership – International Institute for Management Development

MSCS, Computer Science — Columbia Southern University

BSCS, Computer Science — Columbia Southern University

ASCS, Computer Science — University of Maryland

Patents

- [PENDING] - Context-Aware Interactive Bezel for Visualizing and Managing Storage System Operational States
- [PENDING] – Context/Content-Aware Interactive rack door for Visualizing and Managing AI-Infrastructure Operational States